

Global Aerospace & Defense

Space Exploration Technologies Corporation

Rating

Outperform

Price Target



239.00 USD



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SpaceX: Lockup expirations and Q2 - Beginning this week

Our investor discussions regarding SpaceX have been against a backdrop of a large number of lockups expiring this week and through December (and into 2027). SpaceX used an unusually complex scheme with nine main unlock points instead of one traditional 180-day expiry. The design staggers insider selling over roughly the first six months post-IPO, with longer lockups for some institutions and for Elon Musk personally into mid-2027. Lockup expirations begin after the company's Q2 reporting on August 4th. As the lockup timing is well known, expectations have already placed pressure on SpaceX shares. We do not attempt to predict how shares will move as expirations come up in succession into December. But, we have found many investors unwilling to buy SpaceX shares in the interim, based on fundamentals, given the lockup overhang that will exist at least into December.

Despite the fact that lockups create an overhang, we still believe that the company's messaging in its Q2 report will be important. As we stressed in our initiation report, "[Space Exploration Technologies Corporation: Doing Time in the Universal Mind - Initiate at Outperform; Target Price \\$239](#)", the most important factor is the path to fully reusable Starship launches. It will be those launches that can enable the orbital data center plans. We believe a successful earnings call should be as concrete as possible in laying out the path to reaching a high launch cadence. This would include objectives for upcoming launches, more detail on the results of Launch 13 (e.g., heat shield resilience, booster engine relight), and the outlook for launch growth (e.g., launch pad plans). The company needs be clear on how the dream is being translated into reality. Near-term performance numbers and success of Starlink will be interesting. But, those are not what will ultimately deliver the potential value.

Here, we show the timing and size of coming lockup expirations. The first insider lock-up expires on 6 August 2026, when roughly 20-30% of locked shares become eligible for sale. Then staggered unlocks of around 7% of total shares each occur at intervals into October, followed by a Q3-triggered release and a last one at 180 days. These unlocks should increase SpaceX's free float to as much as 40% of outstanding shares by December 2026, with the balance remaining subject to longer-term restrictions, with most free by June 2027.

Investment Implications

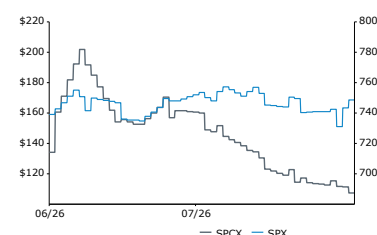
We rate SPCX Outperform, TP \$239, based on 2031 EBITDA for each segment. We use late stage venture discount rates, 25% and 35%, respectively, for Connectivity and AI.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
SPCX (USD)	--	(0.18)	0.83	Revenues (M)	18,674	40,236	84,990	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	(587.4)	131.3	
				Adjusted EBITDA	6,584.0	17,131.0	43,447.0	--	EV/Adj EBITDA (x)	218.7	84.0	33.1

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	31 Jul 2026			
SPCX Close Price (USD)	108.37			
Price Target (USD)	239.00			
Upside/(Downside)	121%			
52-Week Range	225.64/107.01			
SPX	7,489.72			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	NA			
Market Cap (USD) (B)	1,426.06			
EV (USD) (B)	1,439.70			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	NA	(36.6)	NA	NA
SPX (%)	9.4	(0.1)	7.9	18.1
Relative (%)	NA	(36.4)	NA	NA
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.				

Price Performance, 1YR



DETAILS

OVERALL LOCKUP PICTURE

SpaceX successfully completed its IPO on the 12th of June 2026. Since then, the stock has been volatile and recently has fallen below the IPO price. We attribute the recent declines primarily to the potential impact of the coming lockup expirations. We do not attempt to assess the share price impact as the lockups unwind, we lay out the schedule here, which is staged until the 180 day point after the IPO. 180 days after the IPO will be on December 8th.

So far, we have seen little change from the fundamentals for SpaceX since the IPO. We continue to be positive about the long-term outlook, although there are many issues that we have heard from investors (see our July 31, 2026 report, "[SpaceX: The debates - Investor views and controversies as we head toward the first earnings report](#)").

SpaceX has **two-class equity** structure comprising of:

- 7.464bn shares Class A (SPCX US) with 1 voting right listed on Nasdaq on 12 Jun and
- 5.696bn shares Class B (unlisted) with 10 voting rights.

This equity structures are divided into the following cohort breakdown:

- **Floating:** IPO: ~639m shares/~4.9% of total shares (Class A plus Class B).
- **Restricted:**
 - Regular shareholders: ~4.558bn shares/~61.1%
 - Significant holders: ~1.418bn shares/~19%
 - Musk: ~850m shares/~11.4%

KEY LOCKUP DATES

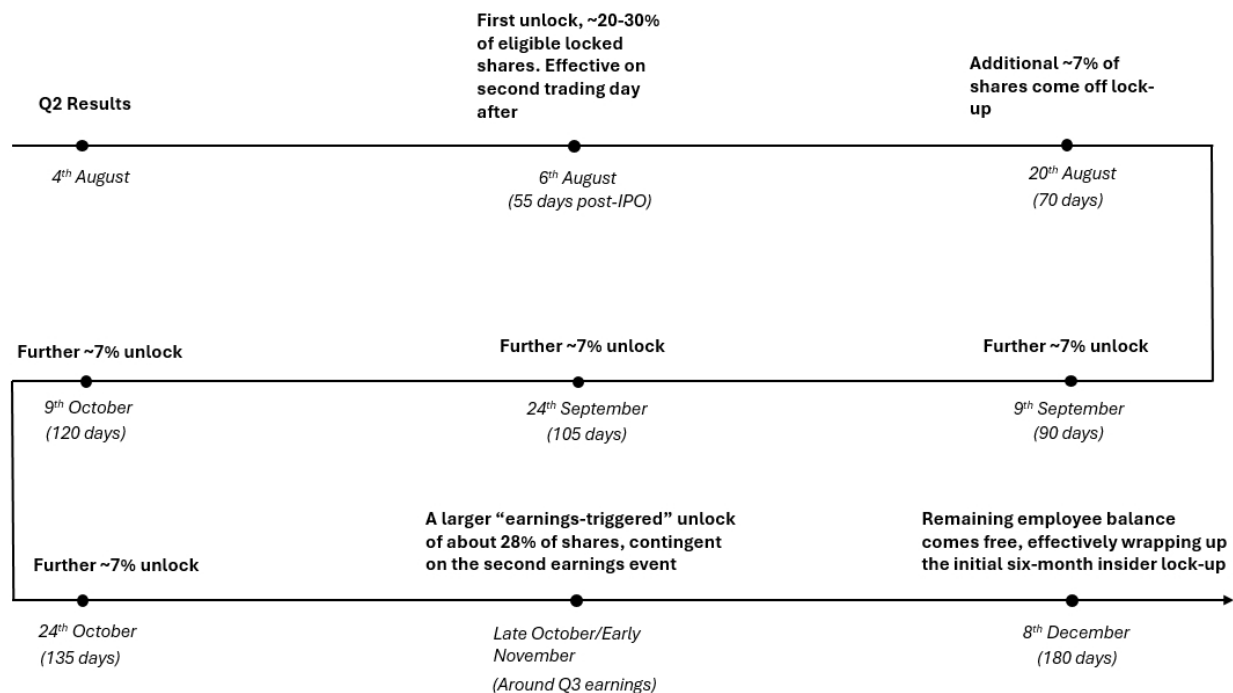
For its lockup periods, Space X used an unusually complex scheme with nine main unlock points instead of one traditional 180-day expiry. The design staggers insider selling over roughly the first six months post-IPO, with longer lock-ups for some institutions and for Elon Musk personally into mid-2027.

Based on SpaceX's S-1 disclosure, the key lock-up dates and indicative supply percentages are:

- **6 August 2026** (55 days post-IPO): First unlock, which is triggered by Q2 reporting, roughly 20% of eligible locked shares become saleable, with an extra 10% could become unrestricted if the stock trades 30% or more above the IPO price (i.e. 175) during 5 of 10 consecutive trading days after the first earnings release.
- **20 August 2026** (70 days): Additional c.7% of total shares come off lock-up.
- **9 September 2026** (90 days): Further c.7% unlock.
- **24 September 2026** (105 days): Another c.7% unlock.
- **9 October 2026** (120 days): Another c.7% unlock.
- **24 October 2026** (135 days): Another c.7% unlock.
- **Late October / early November 2026** (around Q3 earnings): A larger "earnings-triggered" unlock of about 28% of shares, contingent on the second earnings event.
- **8 December 2026** (180 days): Remaining employee balance comes free, effectively wrapping up the initial six-month insider lock-up.

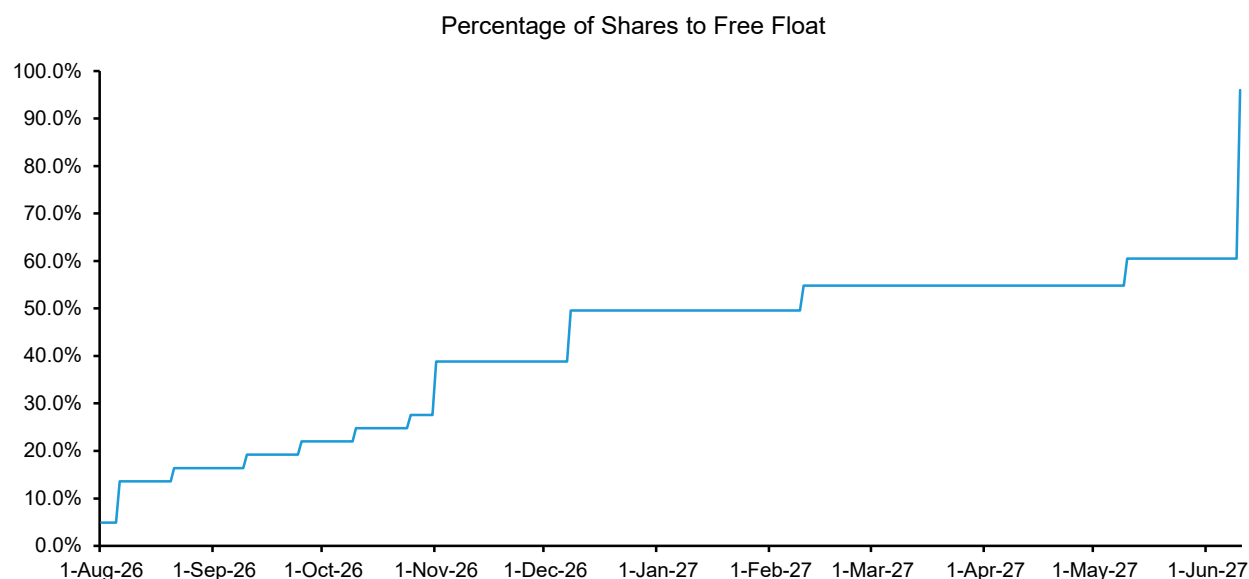
The expiries of lockups through December are expected to lift the free float to up to 40% of the company, with the remainder still subject to extended lockups. In 2027, there will be additional lockup releases triggered by earnings. The founders release will come in June of 2027, one year after the IPO. The lockup periods are shown graphically in Exhibit 1. Exhibit 2 shows the percentage of free float over time as lockup period end through 2027. The dates are approximate for 2027.

EXHIBIT 1: Lockup periods for the next 6 months



Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: Percentage of shares in free float as lockup periods end



Source: Company reports; Bernstein Analysis

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 3: SpaceX Annual Income Statement

SpaceX Annual Income Statement (\$m)								
Fiscal Year Ending December 31	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E
Space	3,796	4,086	4,794	7,560	7,513	7,224	7,930	9,167
Connectivity	7,599	11,387	16,941	27,727	53,120	94,679	140,998	205,908
AI	2,620	3,201	18,501	49,703	103,091	131,330	158,382	339,177
Total Revenues	\$ 14,015	\$ 18,674	\$ 40,236	\$ 84,990	\$ 163,725	\$ 233,233	\$ 307,310	\$ 554,251
Cost of revenue	(7,996)	(9,451)	(15,394)	(29,242)	(55,457)	(77,786)	(95,851)	(158,712)
Research & Development	(3,464)	(8,643)	(20,085)	(37,197)	(27,895)	(37,507)	(43,052)	(86,909)
Selling, General, and administrative	(1,813)	(2,644)	(3,534)	(5,010)	(9,008)	(12,411)	(16,157)	(25,705)
Restructuring charges	(213)	(487)	11	-	-	-	-	-
Impairment	(63)	(38)	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total cost and expenses	-13,549	-21,263	-39,002	-71,448	-92,359	-127,704	-155,060	-271,325
Space	21	(657)	(2,047)	1,262	896	236	503	874
Connectivity	2,006	4,423	6,517	12,164	24,626	44,437	67,304	102,316
AI	(1,561)	(6,355)	(3,236)	115	45,843	60,856	84,443	179,736
Operating income	\$ 466	\$ (2,589)	\$ 1,234	\$ 13,542	\$ 71,365	\$ 105,529	\$ 152,250	\$ 282,926
Interest income (expense)	(1,209)	(1,453)	(1,576)	(3,257)	(6,198)	(12,108)	(17,954)	(19,976)
Other income (expense), net	985	-177	-1876	0	0	0	0	0
Income (loss) before income taxes	\$ 242	\$ (4,219)	\$ (2,218)	\$ 10,285	\$ 65,167	\$ 93,421	\$ 134,296	\$ 262,950
Provisions for (benefit from) income taxes	549	(718)	(59)	(99)	14,202	(2,414)	(4,828)	(39,563)
Net income	\$ 791	\$ (4,937)	\$ (2,278)	\$ 10,186	\$ 79,369	\$ 91,006	\$ 129,467	\$ 223,387
Shares outstanding (mn)								
Basic			11,789	11,789	11,789	11,789	11,789	11,789
Diluted			12,344	12,344	12,344	12,344	12,344	12,344
EPS (\$)								
Basic EPS			-0.19	0.86	6.73	7.72	10.98	18.95
Diluted EPS			-0.18	0.83	6.43	7.37	10.49	18.10
Adjusted EBITDA	\$ 5,350	\$ 6,584	\$ 17,131	\$ 43,447	\$ 112,068	\$ 159,070	\$ 216,453	\$ 403,516
Space	1,154	653	-544	2,817	3,122	2,939	3,768	4,556
Connectivity	3,849	7,168	10,308	17,233	30,947	53,498	78,205	114,737
AI	347	-1,237	7,367	23,397	77,999	102,634	134,480	284,224

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 4: **SpaceX Quarterly Income Statement**

SpaceX Quarterly Income Statement (\$m)											
Fiscal Year Ending December 31											
	2024					2025					2026E
	12 mo	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	12 mo	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	12 mo
Space	3,796	865	746	1,666	809	4,086	619	855	1,538	1,782	4,794
Connectivity	7,599	2,475	2,588	3,096	3,228	11,387	3,257	3,763	4,421	5,500	16,941
AI	2,620	727	737	814	923	3,201	818	1,928	5,640	10,115	18,501
Total Revenues	\$ 14,015	\$ 4,067	\$ 4,071	\$ 5,576	\$ 4,960	\$ 18,674	\$ 4,694	\$ 6,546	\$ 11,599	\$ 17,397	\$ 40,236
Cost of revenue	(7,996)	(1,962)	(2,282)	(2,706)	(2,501)	(9,451)	(2,388)	(2,981)	(4,171)	(5,854)	(15,394)
Research & Development	(3,464)	(1,557)	(1,958)	(2,291)	(2,837)	(8,643)	(3,514)	(4,434)	(4,785)	(7,352)	(20,085)
Selling, General, and administrative	(1,813)	(493)	(606)	(575)	(970)	(2,644)	(746)	(861)	(896)	(1,032)	(3,534)
Restructuring charges	(213)	(4)	(189)	(278)	(16)	(487)	11	-	-	-	11
Impairment	(63)	(24)	(6)	1	(9)	(38)	-	-	-	-	-
Total cost and expenses	-13,549	-4,040	-5,041	-5,849	-6,333	-21,263	-6,637	-8,275	-9,851	-14,239	-39,002
Space	21	-70	-370	258	-475	-657	-662	-756.2535	-319.3394	-309.4451	-2047.038
Connectivity	2006	1033	924	1189	1277	4423	1188	1300.0126	1759.9837	2269.1207	6517.117
AI	(1,561)	(936)	(1,524)	(1,720)	(2,175)	(6,355)	(2,469)	(2,273)	307	1,199	(3,236)
Operating income (loss) from operations	\$ 466	\$ 27	\$ (970)	\$ (273)	\$ (1,373)	\$ (2,589)	\$ (1,943)	\$ (1,729)	\$ 1,747	\$ 3,159	\$ 1,234
Interest income (expense)	(1,209)	(330)	(312)	(359)	(452)	(1,453)	(451)	(633)	(223)	(269)	(1,576)
Other income (expense), net	985	(211)	413	140	(519)	(177)	(1,876)	-	-	-	(1,876)
Income (loss) before income taxes	\$ 242	\$ (514)	\$ (869)	\$ (492)	\$ (2,344)	\$ (4,219)	\$ (4,270)	\$ (2,362)	\$ 1,524	\$ 2,890	\$ (2,218)
Provisions for (benefit from) income taxes	549	(14)	(138)	(562)	(4)	(718)	(6)	-	-	(53)	(59)
Net income	\$ 791	\$ (528)	\$ (1,007)	\$ (1,054)	\$ (2,348)	\$ (4,937)	\$ (4,276)	\$ (2,362)	\$ 1,524	\$ 2,836	\$ (2,278)
Shares outstanding (mn)											
Basic							4,496	5,950	11,789	11,789	11,789
Diluted							5,068	6,507	12,344	12,344	12,344
EPS (\$)											
Basic EPS							-\$0.95	-\$0.40	\$0.13	\$0.24	-\$0.19
Diluted EPS							-\$0.84	-\$0.36	\$0.12	\$0.23	-\$0.18
Adjusted EBITDA	5,350	1,730	1,212	2,168	1,474	6,584	1,127	2,129	6,128	7,748	17,131
Space	1,154	224	-94	672	-149	653	-351	-379	80	106	-544
Connectivity	3,849	1,618	1,583	1,921	2,046	7,168	2,087	2,223	2,719	3,279	10,308
AI	347	-112	-277	-425	-423	-1,237	-609	285	3,329	4,362	7,367

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 5: **SpaceX Annual cash Flow**

SpaceX Annual Cash Flow (\$m)								
Fiscal Year Ending December 31	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E
Net income (loss)	791	(4,937)	(2,278)	10,186	79,369	91,006	129,467	223,387
Depreciation & Amortization	3,824	6,701	12,993	26,621	36,923	49,352	59,556	115,514
Stock Based Compensation	784	1,947	2,915	3,284	3,779	4,189	4,647	5,077
Impairment & Other Charges	63	38	-	-	-	-	-	-
Non-Cash Interest Income and Other	(1,359)	947	998	(703)	(1,031)	(330)	(1,340)	(1,179)
Accounts Receivable	(347)	(543)	(1,838)	(1,240)	(7,320)	(7,385)	(7,076)	(7,881)
Inventory	(309)	(413)	(1,477)	(802)	805	245	(6)	259
Prepaid Expenses & Other	(328)	(673)	(1)	(70)	216	(77)	(66)	(143)
Accounts Payable	472	709	(4,424)	4,273	3,188	7,228	7,066	7,555
Deferred Revenue	1,876	1,929	11,382	809	(3,580)	1,663	6,497	(3,114)
Other Liabilities	309	1,080	4,616	(102)	(1,256)	311	251	420
Net cash provided by operating activities	\$ 5,776	\$ 6,785	\$ 22,887	\$ 42,257	\$ 111,095	\$ 146,203	\$ 198,996	\$ 339,894
Purchase of PPE	(11,163)	(20,619)	(47,643)	(144,226)	(179,933)	(201,296)	(301,139)	(370,695)
Other investing activities, net	367	1,044	(7,812)	-	-	-	-	-
Net cash used in investing activities	\$ (10,796)	\$ (19,575)	\$ (55,455)	\$ (144,226)	\$ (179,933)	\$ (201,296)	\$ (301,139)	\$ (370,695)
Debt Issuance / (Paydown)	(77)	9,131	7,912	77,668	121,525	96,008	45,953	(20,675)
Finance Lease Payments	(154)	(295)	(373)	(470)	(393)	-	-	-
Equity Issuance / (Repurchases) **	12,061	17,514	62,893	(1,653)	(2,432)	(2,553)	(2,123)	(2,781)
Net cash provided by financing activities	\$ 11,830	\$ 26,350	\$ 70,431	\$ 75,545	\$ 118,699	\$ 93,454	\$ 43,830	\$ (23,456)
Effect of exchange rate changes on cash and cash equivalents	1	63	36	-	-	-	-	-
Net change in cash and cash equivalents and restricted cash	\$ 6,811	\$ 13,623	\$ 37,900	\$ (26,425)	\$ 49,861	\$ 38,361	\$ (58,313)	\$ (54,258)
Cash and cash equivalents and restricted cash, beginning year	\$ 4,690	\$ 11,501	\$ 25,124	\$ 63,024	\$ 36,599	\$ 86,461	\$ 124,822	\$ 66,509
Cash and cash equivalents and restricted cash, end year	\$ 11,501	\$ 25,124	\$ 63,024	\$ 36,599	\$ 86,461	\$ 124,822	\$ 66,509	\$ 12,252
FCF	(5,387)	(13,834)	(24,756)	(101,970)	(68,838)	(55,093)	(102,143)	(30,801)
Conversion to net income %	-681%	280%	1087%	-1001%	-87%	-61%	-79%	-14%
Working Capital	(12,177)	(20,272)	(28,530)	(31,398)	(23,452)	(25,438)	(32,104)	(29,199)

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 6: **SpaceX Annual Balance Sheet**

SpaceX Annual Balance Sheet (\$m)								
Fiscal Year Ending December 31	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E
Cash and cash equivalents	11,385	24,747	62,268	35,843	85,705	124,066	65,754	11,496
Marketable securities	800	0	7,823	7,823	7,823	7,823	7,823	7,823
Account receivables (net allowance credit loss)	1,052	1,579	3,417	4,657	11,977	19,362	26,437	34,318
Inventory	2,003	2,416	3,893	4,695	3,890	3,644	3,650	3,392
Prepaid expenses and other current assets	868	2,210	2,211	2,280	2,065	2,142	2,208	2,351
Total current assets	16,108	30,952	79,611	55,298	111,458	157,036	105,871	59,379
Property, plant, and equipment, net	21,147	42,602	77,251	194,856	337,865	489,809	731,392	986,573
Finance lease right-of-use assets	1,686	1,260	892	422	0	0	0	0
Intangible assets, net	2,211	1,548	0	0	0	0	0	0
Digital assets	1,749	1,637	0	0	0	0	0	0
Goodwill	11,129	11,809	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other assets	2,336	2,130	21,354	34,157	22,056	32,583	44,210	55,965
Total non current assets	40,258	60,986	99,497	229,435	359,921	522,392	775,602	1,042,538
Total assets	56,366	91,938	179,108	284,733	471,380	679,428	881,473	1,101,917
Accounts payable	4,413	11,792	7,368	11,641	14,829	22,057	29,123	36,678
Deferred revenue, current	10,179	12,116	23,498	24,307	20,728	22,390	28,887	25,773
Accrued expenses and other liabilities	1,508	2,569	7,185	7,082	5,827	6,138	6,389	6,809
Total current liabilities	16,100	26,477	38,051	43,030	41,383	50,585	64,399	69,259
Debt	12,262	21,659	33,800	111,468	232,993	329,001	374,954	354,279
Finance Lease Liabilities	1,531	1,237	863	393	0	0	0	0
Deferred Tax Liability / (Asset)	-725	-113	8	84	-14,305	-5,136	4,032	13,201
Other Long-Term Liabilities	1,394	1,353	1,293	1,293	1,293	1,293	1,293	1,293
Total non-current liabilities	14,462	24,136	35,964	113,238	219,981	325,158	380,280	368,773
Total liabilities	30,562	50,613	74,015	156,268	261,365	375,743	444,679	438,033
Convertible Preferred Stock	20,941	38,752	0	0	0	0	0	0
Additional Paid-in Capital	35,868	37,710	142,509	155,693	157,874	160,538	164,180	167,883
Retained Earnings	-31,005	-35,137	-37,415	-27,229	52,141	143,147	272,615	496,002
Total shareholders' equity	25,804	41,325	105,094	128,465	210,015	303,685	436,795	663,884
Total liabilities and equity	56,366	91,938	179,109	284,733	471,379	679,428	881,473	1,101,917
Total Debt	13,793	22,896	34,663	111,861	232,993	329,001	374,954	354,279
Net debt	2,408	-1,851	-27,605	76,018	147,288	204,935	309,201	342,783

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis and estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	31 Jul 2026	Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
SPCX (SpaceX)	O	USD	108.37	239.00	NA	USD		(0.18)	0.83		(587.4)	131.3
SPX			7,489.72									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Space Exploration Technologies Corporation**

We base our valuation approach on 12-month forward EV/EBITDA applied to 2031 EBITDA. We believe it is necessary to use a long-term period (i.e., 2031) because the cornerstone of the value is in the orbital data centers. Applying a multiple to, say, 2028 EBITDA would not capture any of that business - i.e., it would simply be space launch, terrestrial compute and near-term Starlink. We use a sum of the parts methodology to give an EV/EBITDA valuation in 2030 (based on 2031 values). We then discount that valuation backward for each segment to mid-2027 in order to provide a one year target price of \$239.

RISKS**Space Exploration Technologies Corporation**

Downside Risks to our Outperform rating and \$239 price target include the ability to dramatically growth Starship launch capacity over time, which depends on full reusability. SpaceX must be able to operationalize its orbital data centers to deliver on the valuation. Semiconductor availability could also be a constraint, as could other potential supply chain issues. There are also risks associated with potential launch incidents or regulatory restrictions. Should compute demand be more limited than most expectations, that would form another risk.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIA) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

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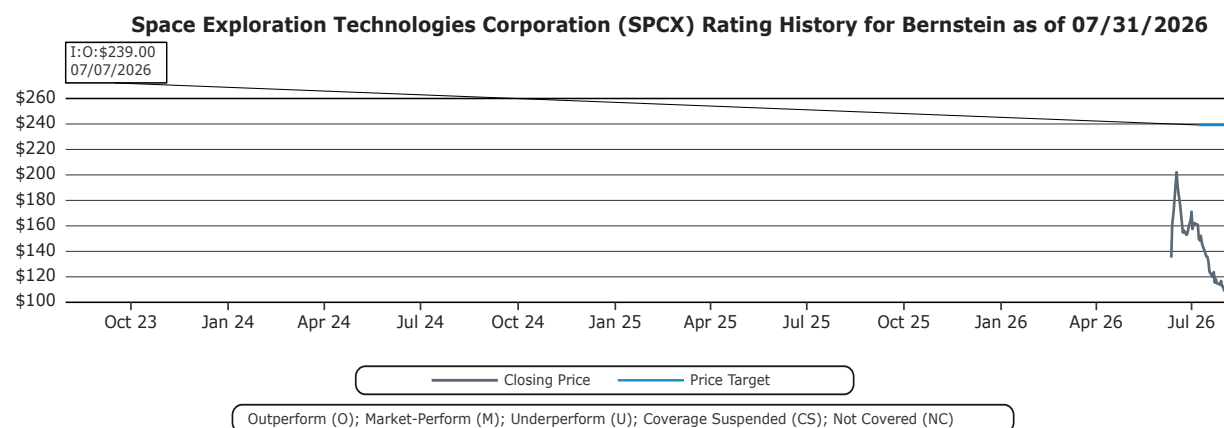
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Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

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